



Twenty minutes here saves us both a month of guessing.

This is every question we would ask you on a discovery call, made fillable. Type straight into it, save, and email it back to hello@forward-framework.com - or print it and write on it.

Answer the first questionnaire if you are not yet sure which service you need; it covers all seven and tells us which is worth doing first. Answer a service questionnaire instead if you already know, and it ends with that service's free deliverable.

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Discovery questionnaire

The full picture. Answer this one if you are not sure which service you need - it tells us which is worth doing first, and what it is worth.

57 questions · 6 sections · answers to hello@forward-framework.com

01 The business

Enough context that nothing we suggest later is generic.

I Why we ask. Everything downstream is priced against what a customer is worth to you. Without this section the rest is opinion.

1 **Your name (required)**

2 **Your role**

3 **Company (required)**

4 **Work email (required)**

5 **Phone**

6 **Website**

7 **In a sentence or two, what do you sell and to whom?**

8 **Describe your best customer. What makes them better than an average one?**

Where you make money is usually narrower than where you make revenue.

9 **How many people work in the business?**

Just me 2–10 11–50 51–200 200+

10 **Annual revenue**

Under \$500K \$500K – \$2M \$2M – \$10M \$10M – \$50M \$50M+ Rather not say

11 **What is actually holding the business back right now?**

Not enough leads Leads don't convert We can't deliver any more than we do Margins are too thin
Everything depends on me Something else

12 **Say more about that**

This is the single most useful answer on the form.

02 How customers find you now

Where demand comes from today, and what it is worth when it arrives.

Why we ask. These five numbers — leads, close rate, customer value, spend, repeat rate — decide which service earns you the most, and in what order. Estimates are fine.

13 **Where do enquiries come from today?**

Referrals and word of mouth Google search Google Ads Meta ads LinkedIn
Social content Email list Cold outreach Events and trade shows Directories and marketplaces
Walk-in or phone Honestly, we're not sure

14 **Enquiries in a typical month**

15 **Roughly what percent do you win?**

%

16 **What is an average new customer worth, first purchase?**

\$

17 **And over the whole relationship?**

\$

18 **How much of your revenue is repeat?**

One-and-done Some repeat Mostly repeat Subscription or contract

19 **Monthly advertising spend**

\$

20 **Who runs the ads?**

Nobody — we don't advertise Me personally Someone in-house A freelancer An agency

21 **Can you trace a sale back to what caused it?**

Every lead, reliably Roughly, for most We guess No idea

22 **Have you asked ChatGPT or Perplexity to recommend a company like yours?**

Worth doing before you answer. It takes thirty seconds and it is often the most uncomfortable thing on this page.

Yes — we get named Yes — we don't get named No, never tried it

23 **Name two or three competitors you lose to**

24 **When you lose one, why?**

03 Your website and your tools

What the site is supposed to do, and what it actually does.

Why we ask. A site that loads slowly, hides its offer, or cannot be updated without a developer is a tax on every other channel you pay for.

25 **What is the site built on?**

WordPress Shopify Squarespace Wix Webflow Custom build I don't know
We don't have a website

26 **When was it last rebuilt?**

Within a year 1–3 years ago 3–5 years ago More than 5 years ago Never — it's the original

27 **What is the site's job?**

Generate enquiries Sell directly Explain what we do Book appointments Recruit staff
It's a brochure Not sure

28 **What do people complain about, or what makes you wince?**

29 **Who changes the site when something needs changing?**

Anyone on the team One person in-house An outside developer Me, reluctantly
Nobody — it hasn't changed in years

30 **What software does the business run on?**

CRM, quoting, scheduling, field service, accounting, email, phones, spreadsheets that should not be load-bearing.

31 **Do those tools talk to each other?**

Everything is connected Some of it Nothing talks to anything I don't know

04 **Where the hours go**

The part most owners have never added up.

Why we ask. Every hour below is a real cost that repeats every week, forever, until something changes. Rough numbers are fine — the order of magnitude is what matters.

32 **When an enquiry arrives, how fast does a human respond?**

MIT and InsideSales studied 15,000 leads: those contacted inside five minutes were 21 times more likely to qualify than those contacted after thirty. This is usually the cheapest money on the table.

Under 5 minutes Within an hour Same day Next day Honestly? Sometimes never

33 **What happens to an enquiry that doesn't buy straight away?**

An automated sequence follows up We follow up manually, consistently
We follow up when someone remembers Nothing happens

34 **Hours a week spent copying information between systems**

hrs

35 **Hours a week producing quotes, proposals or estimates**

hrs

36 **Hours a week on scheduling and rescheduling**

hrs

37 **Hours a week assembling reports someone asked for**

hrs

38 **Hours a week chasing customers, suppliers or your own team**

hrs

39 **Roughly what does an hour of that person's time cost you?**

Fully loaded — salary, tax, benefits, the lot.

\$

40 **If you could delete one recurring task forever, what would it be?**

41 **When something falls through the cracks, where does it usually fall?**

05 The business without you

What is written down, and what only exists in someone's head.

Why we ask. Undocumented process is the cost you cannot see until the week the person holding it is unavailable — and it is the reason most owners cannot take a real holiday.

42 Are your processes written down?

Written down and actually followed Written down but ignored They live in people's heads
What processes?

43 Whose two-week absence would hurt most, and what would break?

44 How does a new hire learn the job?

A structured programme Shadowing a colleague Trial by fire We haven't hired in years

45 People you expect to hire in the next 12 months

None 1–2 3–5 6–10 More than 10

46 Does everyone sell the same way?

Same process every time Loosely the same Every rep does their own thing
One person does all the selling

47 If you vanished for 30 days, what happens?

It runs fine Bumpy, but it survives Revenue stops I would rather not think about it

06 What 'worth it' looks like

So we can price against your definition of success rather than ours.

Why we ask. We quote a fixed price against a written outcome. This section is the outcome.

48 What would have to be true 90 days from now for this to have been worth it?

49 And twelve months from now?

50 Which of these sound relevant?

Every one of them starts with something free. Tick as many as you like.

Web design & development AI consulting Automation Marketing, SEO & AI search
Ad management Social media marketing Business systems & SOPs Not sure — tell us

51 **What have you got in mind to invest?**

Not a commitment. It stops us proposing something you would never buy.

Under \$1K \$1K – \$5K \$5K – \$15K \$15K – \$50K \$50K+ No idea — advise me

52 **When do you want this moving?**

Immediately Within 30 days This quarter This year Just exploring

53 **Who else signs off?**

Just me Me and one other A small group A board or committee

54 **What would stop this happening?**

Nothing — we're ready Budget approval Timing Internal capacity Trust — we've been burned

55 **What have you already tried that didn't work?**

Blunt saves us both time. We will not be offended by the last agency's name.

56 **Anything that is non-negotiable?**

57 **Anything we haven't asked that we should have?**

Web Design & Development questionnaire

Enough to design a real concept rather than a template, and to quote a build without a discovery call first.

26 questions · 3 sections · answers to hello@forward-framework.com

01 The site you have

What exists today, and what has to survive.

Why we ask. Half of a redesign is deciding what not to throw away. Rankings, content and integrations are expensive to rebuild by accident.

1 The site we should be looking at

2 What is it built on?

WordPress Shopify Squarespace Wix Webflow Custom build I don't know
We don't have one yet

3 Who built it, and can you still reach them?

4 Roughly how many pages?

Under 10 10–30 30–100 100–500 500+

5 Monthly visitors

6 What percent turn into an enquiry?

%

7 Do you have analytics we could look at?

Yes — GA4 Yes — something else It's installed but nobody looks No analytics at all

8 Anything on the current site that must survive the rebuild?

9 What do you dislike most about it?

02 What the new one has to do

The job, the audience, and the proof we have to work with.

I Why we ask. A homepage can do one thing well. Deciding which one, before design starts, is most of the conversion work.

10 What is the single most valuable thing a visitor can do?

Call us Fill in a form Book an appointment Buy online Apply or submit documents
Download something Not sure

11 Who is it for? List every distinct audience.

12 What proof do you already have?

Written reviews Video testimonials Case studies with numbers Photos of real work
Certifications or licences Awards Recognisable client logos Nothing yet

13 Where is the brand?

Full brand guide exists Logo and colours only Nothing consistent It needs a rebrand

14 What about the words?

Written and approved Rough drafts exist We need it written for us Reuse what's on the site now

15 And photography?

Professional shots, current Professional but dated Phone photos of real work Stock only
Nothing

16 What does the site need to connect to?

CRM Booking or scheduling Payments Live chat Inventory or ERP Email marketing
A customer portal Nothing

17 Two or three sites you admire — and what you admire about them

Competitors or not. "I like how obvious the next step is" is more useful than "I like the blue".

18 Is there a date this has to be live by, and why?

You Where to send it

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26 **Anything we haven't asked that we should have?**

AI Consulting questionnaire

Enough to rank real use cases by value and risk, instead of handing you a list of tools.

20 questions · 3 sections · answers to hello@forward-framework.com

01 Where judgement lives

The decisions and the data behind them.

Why we ask. AI is worth money where a human currently applies judgement to information, repeatedly. Finding those spots is the whole audit.

1 **Which decisions get made by feel rather than by rule?**

2 **What repetitive judgement call happens most often, and how many times a day?**

3 **Where does the information those decisions need actually live?**

A CRM Spreadsheets Email inboxes A database Paper or PDFs
An ERP or field system Recorded calls People's heads

4 **If you had to grade that data, honestly**

Clean and current Mostly fine Messy but salvageable A disaster I genuinely don't know

5 **What have you tried already?**

ChatGPT or Claude, ad hoc Copilot in Microsoft 365 An AI feature inside a tool we pay for
A custom build A vendor pilot that went nowhere Nothing yet

6 **How did that go?**

02 Constraints and ownership

What we have to design around.

Why we ask. Most AI projects fail on governance, not on models. Better to know the rules before we propose anything.

7 **Are you in a regulated space?**

HIPAA / healthcare Financial services Legal Government or defence Education
GDPR-relevant EU data None of these

8 **What worries you about it?**

Accuracy and hallucination Customer data privacy How clients would react Staff resistance
Ongoing cost Regulation changing Being locked into a vendor Nothing — I'm impatient

9 **How would your team react to this?**

Enthusiastic Curious but cautious Quietly resistant Openly hostile Mixed

10 **Who inside would own an AI system once it exists?**

11 **Any preference between buying a tool and building one?**

Buy — we don't want to maintain anything Build — we want it to fit us exactly Whichever pays back faster
No view

12 **What would make this obviously worth it?**

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20 **Anything we haven't asked that we should have?**

Automation questionnaire

Enough to map one process end to end and put hours and dollars against automating it.

22 questions · 3 sections · answers to hello@forward-framework.com

01 The process itself

Pick the one that annoys you most and walk us through it.

I Why we ask. Automation is priced per workflow. One process described properly is worth more than ten described vaguely.

1 **Which process are we talking about?**

2 **Walk it through, step by step. Name every place a human retypes something.**

The retyping is where the money is. Be tediously literal.

3 **How many times a month does it run?**

4 **Minutes it takes, each time**

min

5 **How many people touch it?**

6 **Roughly, cost of an hour of their time**

\$

7 **What happens when it goes wrong?**

8 **What else is on the list after this one?**

02 The systems it runs on

What we would be connecting.

Why we ask. Whether a workflow takes days or weeks comes down to whether the tools involved have decent APIs and who holds the logins.

9 Every piece of software this touches

10 Which moments should set something off automatically?

A new enquiry arrives A quote is accepted A job is scheduled A job is completed
An invoice is raised A payment lands A customer goes quiet A review is due A reorder is due

11 Is anything automated today?

Zapier or Make is running Native integrations between tools Custom code someone wrote
Nothing at all I don't know

12 Do those tools have APIs, and do you have admin access?

Yes to both Admin yes, APIs unknown Some tools, not all No idea — find out for us

13 How fast does a human currently reply to a new enquiry?

Under 5 minutes Within an hour Same day Next day Sometimes never

14 Who would look after these automations afterwards?

Someone technical in-house Me, with documentation Nobody — we'd want you to hold it
Not thought about it

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22 **Anything we haven't asked that we should have?**

Marketing, SEO & AI Search questionnaire

Enough to run your category's real buying prompts and tell you why you are or are not in the answer.

22 questions · 3 sections · answers to hello@forward-framework.com

01 Demand and geography

What people search — or ask — right before they need you.

I Why we ask. The prompts we test have to be the ones your buyers actually use. Yours will be better than ours.

1 What would someone type, or ask an AI, moments before they need you?

Write them as real sentences. "Who's the best commercial roofer in Pittsburgh" beats "roofing".

2 Where do you serve?

3 Do you need to rank in more than one town or region?

One location A handful of towns Whole state or region Nationwide International

4 Who currently comes up when you search?

5 Have you asked an AI to recommend someone in your category?

Yes — we get named Yes — a competitor gets named Yes — nobody local gets named

No, never tried

6 If you tried it, paste what it said

02 What is already in place

Content, reputation and history.

I Why we ask. AI answers are assembled from what already exists about you elsewhere. Reviews and citations often move the needle faster than anything on your own site.

7 Who writes anything that goes on the site?

Someone in-house A freelancer An agency Me Nobody

8 How often does something new go up?

Weekly Monthly A few times a year It hasn't changed in years

9 **Google Business Profile**

Claimed and active Claimed but neglected Not claimed Doesn't apply to us I don't know

10 **Roughly how many reviews do you have?**

11 **Average rating**

12 **Where are they?**

Google Facebook Yelp Industry directory Our own site Trustpilot or similar
Nowhere yet

13 **Has anyone written about you — press, directories, associations?**

14 **Has anyone done SEO for you before? What happened?**

Including the bad experiences. Especially those.

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22 **Anything we haven't asked that we should have?**

Ad Management questionnaire

Enough to tell you where the budget is leaking before you hire anyone — including us.

22 questions · 3 sections · answers to hello@forward-framework.com

01 What is running now

Platforms, spend and who holds the keys.

Why we ask. Account ownership and tracking decide whether an audit is possible at all, and whether you can leave any agency cleanly.

1 Where are you spending?

☐ Google Search
 ☐ Google Performance Max
 ☐ Google Display
 ☐ YouTube
☐ Meta (Facebook/Instagram)
 ☐ LinkedIn
 ☐ TikTok
 ☐ Microsoft/Bing
 ☐ Local Services Ads
☐ Nowhere yet

2 Roughly how is the monthly budget split?

3 Who owns the ad accounts?

If an agency owns them, you cannot take your history with you. Worth checking today.

☐ We do
 ☐ An agency does
 ☐ A freelancer does
 ☐ I genuinely don't know

4 Who manages them day to day?

☐ Nobody, really
 ☐ Me
 ☐ Someone in-house
 ☐ A freelancer
 ☐ An agency

5 What does a lead cost you now?

\$

6 What would it need to be?

\$

02 Tracking, creative and offers

The three things that decide whether spend works.

Why we ask. Most wasted budget is not bad bidding. It is a platform optimising towards the wrong event because nobody told it what a good customer looks like.

7 What counts as a conversion today?

☐ Qualified leads only
 ☐ Any form fill or call
 ☐ Page views or clicks
 ☐ Nothing is tracked
 ☐ I don't know

8 Do closed deals get sent back into the ad platforms?

This is usually the single biggest lever in a lead-gen account.

☐ Yes, automatically
 ☐ Yes, manually
 ☐ No
 ☐ What does that mean?

9 **Is your CRM connected to the ad platforms?**

Yes Partially No We don't have a CRM

10 **Where does the traffic land?**

Dedicated landing pages Relevant site pages The homepage A mix

11 **Who makes the ads?**

An agency In-house A freelancer Platform auto-generated Whatever was there last year

12 **What is the offer in the ad right now?**

13 **Does demand swing through the year?**

14 **Best and worst campaign you have ever run — and why**

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Under \$1K

\$1K – \$5K

\$5K – \$15K

\$15K – \$50K

\$50K+

No idea — advise me

22 **Anything we haven't asked that we should have?**

Social Media Marketing questionnaire

Enough to script ten posts in your voice, about things only you could say.

21 questions · 3 sections · answers to hello@forward-framework.com

01 Where you are now

Channels, cadence and who is actually doing it.

I Why we ask. A content plan nobody can execute is worthless. What you can realistically film and post decides the plan's shape.

1 Which channels matter to you?

Instagram Facebook TikTok LinkedIn YouTube X / Twitter Pinterest
Nextdoor None yet

2 Your handles or profile links

3 How often does something go out?

Daily A few times a week Weekly Monthly When we remember Never

4 Who makes the content?

Me Someone in-house A freelancer An agency Nobody

5 Is anyone willing to be on camera?

There is a plan either way. It is just a different plan.

Yes, happily Yes, reluctantly Someone else on the team will Absolutely nobody

6 Realistically, how much filming can you do?

A day a month A few hours a month Grab clips as we work None — use what we already have

7 What do you already have sitting on a phone or drive?

Job site photos Before and afters Video clips Customer testimonials Team photos
Product shots Nothing

02 What you actually know

The raw material nobody else has.

I Why we ask. The posts that work are the ones only you could write. Generic advice is what everyone else is already posting.

8 What do you know that your customers don't?

The things you explain over and over. Those are your best posts.

9 **What do customers ask you every single time?**

10 **Best-performing thing you have ever posted — and why you think it worked**

11 **What is social actually for, here?**

Getting known locally

Generating enquiries

Recruiting staff

Proof for people already considering us

Building an audience we own

12 **Anything that is off limits?**

13 **Would you put money behind what works?**

Yes

Maybe, once it proves out

Organic only

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\$50K+

No idea — advise me

21 **Anything we haven't asked that we should have?**

Scaffold — Business Systems questionnaire

Enough to name every process living in someone's head and rank it by what it costs you.

22 questions · 3 sections · answers to hello@forward-framework.com

01 How the work gets done

Who does what, and whether any of it is written down.

Why we ask. Risk sits wherever a process exists in exactly one person. Naming those is the whole exercise.

1 **Who does what? Roles rather than names is fine.**

2 **Which parts are written down anywhere?**

Sales Delivery and operations Finance and billing Hiring and onboarding Marketing
Customer service Safety and compliance None of it

3 **Where would someone look for a written process?**

A proper system everyone uses Google Drive or SharePoint Someone's laptop
A binder in the office Nowhere

4 **Whose two-week absence would hurt most, and what would break?**

5 **Where does the customer's experience change depending on who is working?**

6 **If you disappeared for 30 days, what happens?**

It runs fine Bumpy, but it survives Revenue stops I would rather not think about it

02 People and direction

Hiring, training and where this is all heading.

Why we ask. Documentation is worth building only against what you are trying to become — a business you can hand over, sell, or simply stop carrying.

7 **People you expect to hire in the next 12 months**

None 1–2 3–5 6–10 More than 10

8 **Weeks until a new hire is genuinely productive**

wks

9 **Where does hiring hurt most?**

Finding candidates Telling good from bad Onboarding them Keeping them All of it

10 **How is staff turnover?**

Very low Normal for our industry Higher than we'd like A revolving door

11 **What regular meetings exist?**

Daily huddle and weekly leadership Weekly team meeting Monthly, roughly None

12 **What numbers does leadership look at every week?**

"None" is a completely normal answer and a useful one.

13 **What are you building towards?**

A business I could sell A business that runs without me Handing it to family or staff
Just growing it, no exit in mind Haven't decided

14 **If one process were documented tomorrow, which would you pick?**

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